

Types of joint

There are more than 400 joints in a human skeleton. Most of these are the synovial (movable) joints that allow us to run or shake our head. Others are fixed, or permit only limited movements.

Movable joints

There are six types of movable joint in the body. Each type allows a different range of movement, shown here by arrows. Which way the bones can move depends on how their ends fit together in the joint. For example, the ball-and-socket joint in the hip allows the leg to swing in most directions.

OTHER TYPES

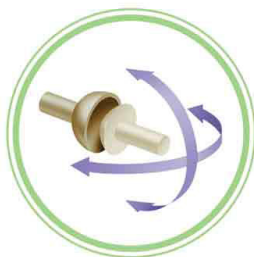


All 22 skull bones, except one in the jaw, are locked together by **fixed joints**.



Semimovable joints, such as those between the vertebrae in the backbone and between the hip bones shown here, allow limited movement.

Saddle joint allows the thumb to move freely and touch the other fingers.



Ellipsoidal joint in the knuckles and wrists allows up-and-down and side-to-side movements.